

From a Ziploc bag in Peru to Anniston's favorite coffee shop

Jerod Snider never planned to open a coffee shop. [Yahoo!](#) A Christian missionary living in the Peruvian Andes, he stumbled into the coffee business in 2017 when a church member handed him a small Ziploc bag of beans [Yahoo!](#) from her father's hillside farm — and that single taste changed the trajectory of his life. [yahoo](#) Today, Called Coffee Company at **1400 Quintard Ave in Anniston, Alabama** [Yelp](#) stands as a thriving brick-and-mortar shop with drive-thru, in-house roasting, and a direct-trade relationship with a Peruvian farming family whose income has increased roughly **tenfold** through the partnership. What started with handmade carts and a Facebook Marketplace espresso machine [Yahoo!](#) has become the top-rated independent coffee shop in Anniston, winning the Calhoun County Chamber of Commerce's **Emerging Small Business of the Year** award [Food & Beverage Services](#) and earning devoted customers who say it beats every chain they've tried.

A missionary's accidental path into coffee

Jerod Snider grew up in Calhoun County, Alabama. [calhounjournal](#) [Calhoun Journal](#) No public records detail his formal education or pre-missionary career, but by 2016 he and his wife **Hannah Snider** had long dreamed of nonprofit work and church planting. That year, the couple sold everything they owned and moved to **Huancayo, Peru** with their 8-month-old daughter. [Yahoo!](#) Their mission work in the mountainous Junín region included distributing food, mentoring youth, and helping plant a church whose operations they intended to hand over to local leadership. [Yahoo!](#)

The pivotal moment came when a church member named **Elisa**, daughter of coffee farmer Gregorio Torre, brought Jerod a small bag of coffee from her father's farm. "I had no idea they had a coffee farm," Snider told *The Anniston Star* in June 2025. "I tasted it, and at that time, it was the best coffee I had ever had." [yahoo](#) When Gregorio and his wife Isabel asked if the Sniders could help bring their beans to the United States, [Anniston Star](#) Jerod agreed [Anniston Star](#) — despite knowing nothing about the coffee trade. He traveled **12 hours into the jungle** to visit La Vida Dor, the Torre family's farm [Yahoo!](#) perched at 1,700–2,000 meters elevation in San Martín de Pangoa, [Nonfictioncoffee](#) hauling donated water filters from the North Carolina nonprofit Wine to Water. [Yahoo!](#)

Over months, Snider taught himself the intricacies of specialty-grade coffee: picking, de-pulping, washing, drying, grading, and eventually roasting. [Yahoo!](#) His first export involved paying a young Peruvian exporter \$6,000 on trust that the beans would arrive in the U.S. They did — and **Non-Fiction Coffee Co. in Birmingham** agreed to buy as much as he could send. [Yahoo!](#) The Sniders returned to Alabama when Hannah's second pregnancy involved serious medical complications that, in Jerod's assessment, "may not have been survivable in Peru." [yahoo](#)

From handmade carts to a Quintard Avenue storefront

Called Coffee's evolution traces a scrappy, improvisational arc through four distinct phases. In **late 2018**, Jerod launched with a pair of handmade carts and a secondhand espresso machine, working local events like the Noble Street Festival. [Yahoo!](#) By **mid-2019**, he had built out a coffee truck [Calhoun Journal](#) that debuted at Oxford's Festival of Lights, where **300 customers** showed up on night one. "We had never done it before. We had no idea what we were doing, and we just started making drinks. And we survived that night and ran out of everything," he recalled. [Yahoo!](#) [yahoo](#)

Snider went full-time in **March 2020** — two weeks before COVID-19 shut down his entire event calendar. He pivoted to parking the truck at local businesses during weekday mornings. [calhounjournal](#) [Calhoun Journal](#) A brief **pop-up inside Quintard Mall** in Oxford (ribbon-cutting October 2021) [Calhoun Journal](#) [Food & Beverage Services](#) bridged the gap while he renovated a permanent location. In **February 2023**, the brick-and-mortar Called Coffee opened in the **former Daylight Donuts building** at 1400 Quintard Ave, [Yahoo!](#) featuring an in-house **Diedrich IR-12 roaster** capable of roasting 20 pounds every 15 minutes [Food & Beverage Services](#) and a drive-thru window that now accounts for roughly **70% of revenue**. [Yahoo!](#)

The shop operates Monday through Friday from 6 AM to 7 PM and Saturday from 8 AM to 4 PM, closed Sundays. [Yelp](#) Pricing runs notably low for specialty coffee — reviewers call it "the cheapest espresso in the country" [Roadtrippers](#) — with honey lattes at \$4.95–\$5.45 and cappuccinos at \$3.95. [Called Coffee](#) The menu features signature drinks like the **Snow Day Latte** (white mocha and hazelnut), **Honey Lavender Latte**, and **Coconut Mocha**, alongside cold brew, matcha, teas, and pastries [Wheree](#) sourced daily from Artisanal Baked Goods in Anniston. [Calhoun Journal](#) Called Coffee also sells retail bags of roasted beans and K-cups for home brewing. [Called Coffee](#)

Faith, fair trade, and a farming family transformed

The name "Called" carries explicit spiritual meaning. "We believe that everybody's called to do something," Snider explains. "There's always something you can do to help

somebody else out." [Yahoo!](#) The business operates as a for-profit entity, but its entire model is structured around Snider's missionary calling: revenue funds ongoing mission work in Peru, [Calhoun Journal](#) and the direct-trade relationship with the Torre family sits at the heart of the operation.

The economic impact on the Peruvian partners has been dramatic. When Gregorio Torre first sold his beans locally, he earned roughly **5 soles per kilo** (about 70 cents per pound). Through Called Coffee's direct purchasing, that price has risen to **28 soles per kilo** (approximately \$8 per pound) [Yahoo!](#) — a figure Snider says he's "super proud of."

[Yahoo!](#) [yahoo](#) Beyond price improvements, the partnership has funded construction of a proper wash tank, drying beds, and even a road on the farm. [Yahoo!](#) [yahoo](#) The ripple effects extend further: Gregorio's son **Eddie**, who once "wanted nothing to do with the coffee business," now **runs his own coffee shop in Huancayo** featuring his father's beans. [Yahoo!](#) [yahoo](#) Called Coffee and Non-Fiction Coffee Co. remain the only two roasters outside Peru with access to the Torre family's [Nonfictioncoffee](#) **Caturra and Bourbon** variety beans. [Nonfictioncoffee](#)

Locally, Called Coffee's community footprint extends well beyond serving drinks. The shop partners with several regional small businesses, [Calhoun Journal](#) hosts "**Coffee with the Chamber**" events for the Calhoun County Chamber of Commerce, [Calhoun Journal](#) and actively supports **Martha's Hope**, a local homeless shelter whose opening helped resolve early challenges the shop faced with homelessness near its Quintard Avenue location. [yahoo](#) Snider spoke to the **Calhoun County Rotary Club** in June 2025 about his journey, [Anniston Star](#) and he continues to travel to Peru for mission work — noting with characteristic humor that he loves having "a reason and a tax write-off for my trips to Peru because it's for business." [Calhoun Journal](#)

Customers rate it the best coffee in Anniston

Customer reception has been overwhelmingly positive across every review platform. Called Coffee holds a **99/100 health score** on Yelp, [Yelp](#) a **4.5-star rating** on MenuPix [MenuPix](#) (ranked **#1 coffee shop in Anniston**), [MenuPix](#) and consistently glowing reviews on Google. Recurring themes across dozens of reviews include exceptional friendliness ("staff that feels like family"), surprisingly affordable pricing, high-quality in-house-roasted coffee, and a clean, welcoming atmosphere.

Representative customer quotes paint a clear picture:

- "This is my absolute favorite coffee shop — better than Starbucks, better than Scooters, and honestly better than any out-of-town coffee shop I've ever tried."

[Called Coffee](#)

- “The owner has an amazing heart for serving the community. Love Called Coffee!”

Called Coffee

- “Started coming here after a bad experience at Starbucks. I have only had good experiences here! The prices are amazing especially for the quality.” [Roadtrippers](#)
- “The cold brew is smooth and delicious. The empanadas are a smidge pricey but stupidly tasty. And they are dog friendly.” [roadtrippers](#)

The shop’s only notable chain competitor in Anniston is **Scooter’s Coffee**, which opened in March 2022 [Scooter's Coffee](#) — but customers consistently rank Called Coffee higher on quality, price, and atmosphere. The TripAdvisor listing remains unclaimed with zero reviews, [Tripadvisor](#) suggesting an opportunity for greater tourism visibility. On social media, the **@calledcoffee** Instagram account has approximately **2,182 followers** with 218 posts, [Instagram](#) a solid presence for a single-location independent shop in a small Alabama city.

What makes Called Coffee distinctive

Several factors set Called Coffee apart from virtually any other small-town coffee shop in the region. The **end-to-end story** — from Peruvian mission field to Alabama drive-thru — is genuinely unusual in the specialty coffee world. Most “direct trade” relationships are commercial arrangements; Snider’s began in a church and grew from personal friendship. The business also demonstrates a rare dual-impact model: it serves the local Anniston community while materially transforming the economic circumstances of a farming family on another continent.

Snider’s philosophy remains strikingly humble for someone whose business has won chamber awards and earned local media profiles. “I’ve never started it with an intention of doing any of this,” he told *The Anniston Star*. “I was just trying to sell a bag. Still don’t know what’s next.” [Yahoo!](#) He has mentioned potential future expansion through small kiosks, shops in other towns, or additional trucks, and expressed a goal of spending two to three months per year in Peru. [Calhoun Journal](#) But planning has never been his style — Called Coffee exists because a farmer’s daughter brought a missionary a Ziploc bag of beans, and everything since has unfolded from there. [yahoo](#)

Conclusion

Called Coffee represents something increasingly rare: a business whose origin story is not a branding exercise but an actual, verifiable account of accidental entrepreneurship rooted in faith and human connection. Jerod Snider’s lack of formal coffee industry training turned out to be irrelevant — what mattered was his willingness to say yes to

helping a Peruvian family and his persistence through handmade carts, a pandemic, and a complete career reinvention. The shop's competitive prices, in-house roasting of single-origin beans, and genuine community warmth have made it Anniston's clear favorite. Perhaps most notably, the Torre family's journey from subsistence-level coffee prices to nearly \$8 per pound — and a second generation now opening their own café [Yahoo!](#) [yahoo](#) — suggests that Called Coffee's impact extends far beyond what any Quintard Avenue drive-thru customer might guess while picking up their Monday morning Honey Lavender Latte.